

*L*A_T_EX Labs

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Overleaf Introduction

While there are options to download and fine-tune software for creating and processing $\text{\LaTeX}$ documents on your machine, as a beginner it can be a daunting task to get all of the appropriate software and settings just right. To make things easy for us, we will be using Overleaf, an online $\text{\LaTeX}$ editor.

1.1 Setting up your account

To begin, visit [Overleaf](https://www.overleaf.com)¹ and click the "sign up" icon in the top right. You may link to a Google account, or create an account manually with your email and password. You will need to confirm your email address, then enter some details about yourself. *You do not need the premium version*, so go ahead and "skip" when you are offered the option.

Finally, you will reach a page with three options:

- Create a new project
- Learn $\text{\LaTeX}$ with a tutorial
- Browse templates

The $\text{\LaTeX}$ tutorial may be a helpful second resource, with a lot of overlap with these $\text{\LaTeX}$ labs. Feel free to bookmark the link if you want to visit the tutorial later. For now, click *Create a new project* and select *Blank project*. Enter a title in the format "lastname-lab-1" (with your last name in place of "lastname", e.g. "ramsey-lab-1") and click Create.

1.2 Your first project

Take a look at what you see in the project page:

- Along the top navigation bar, you should see the typical options File, Edit, Insert, View, Format, Help. In the center is the name of your document, and clicking the name gives you a few different options. On the right are some icons and a button to Share and Upgrade.
- In the left column, there is a File Tree. Sometimes $\text{\LaTeX}$ projects can get very large and feature a multitude of files, and this is a way to keep

¹www.overleaf.com